

Harlem Renaissance Library

Grades 3–5 • Activity Card

● Yellow Level

Name: _____ Class: _____

Aaron Douglas and Langston Hughes were friends who worked in the same neighbourhood at the same time. Douglas painted the visual language of the Renaissance; Hughes wrote the verbal language. Both were making the same argument: *Black culture is beautiful, powerful, and worthy of the finest art.*

ACTIVITY 1: COMPARE ART AND POETRY



Douglas — Song of the Towers

"I, too, sing America.

I am the darker brother.

They send me to eat in the kitchen when company comes,

But I laugh, and eat well, and grow strong.

Tomorrow, I'll be at the table..."

— Langston Hughes, 1926

What argument do BOTH the painting and the poem make? Write 2–3 sentences:

ACTIVITY 2: RESEARCH

Find one library book about the Harlem Renaissance. Write the title and one fact you didn't know before:

Book: _____

New fact:



minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance